MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

CORE REVISION GUIDE • FULL COMPREHENSION MANUAL

LEVEL 2



READING SKILLS

A comprehensive guide to textual analysis, comparison and synthesis for Level 2

Synthesis & Comparison | Tone, Bias & Voice | Language Techniques | Mock Papers

ENGLISH READING LEVEL 2

Functional Skills English • Reading

Level 2 • Comprehensive Textual Analysis & Comparison Manual

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:
_____	_____	_____

What is inside

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How to use this book

Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

Try
Write your answers on the lines.

Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE • DFE SUBJECT CONTENT L2.9 TO L2.18

SPEC

Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Reading • Specification Overview

Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Reading Assessment Architecture

Examination Structure: The Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 2 Reading paper is an externally assessed, **75-minute** examination worth **35 marks**.

Candidates must analyse and synthesize evidence across **three extended non-fiction texts** on a shared theme (e.g. workplace automation, healthcare ethics, environmental policy, or community regeneration).

- **Core Challenge Areas:** Advanced implicit meaning, tone and register analysis, detecting subtle bias and propaganda, evaluating rhetorical and presentational devices, and synthesis across multiple sources.
- **The 11-Mark Comparison Question:** The flagship question requiring candidates to compare ideas, arguments, and perspectives across two texts using direct comparative connectives and an evidence grid.
- **Timing:** Approximately **2 minutes per mark**. Spend 15 minutes reading all three source passages thoroughly.

Band 4 Comparison Rule

For the 11-mark comparison question, ensure you provide balanced points from BOTH texts with direct comparative links.

Critical Audit Trap

Do not confuse tone with purpose. Purpose is what the writer wants to achieve; tone is their attitude and voice.

✎ Personal Target Score & High-Yield Topic Priorities

AUDIT

BASELINE SKILLS AUDIT • LEVEL 2 READING

Candidate Diagnostic Self-Audit Matrix

Core Functional Skills Level 2 Reading Competencies

Assess your confidence across the advanced Level 2 Reading competencies before beginning:

- Can you identify subtle bias in texts that appear neutral on the surface?
- Can you unpack implicit meanings, subtext, and irony in extended professional prose?
- Can you evaluate how rhetorical devices (rule of three, hyperbole, rhetorical questions) sway reader opinion?
- Can you systematically construct a side-by-side comparison of two authors' contrasting viewpoints?
- Can you explain exactly how layout and typography direct reader attention and convey authority?

✎ Target Areas for Maximum Mark Gains

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R1 Reading Topic 1: Fact or Opinion



Professional context for Fact or Opinion.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.9 / L2.9:** Identify and distinguish between fact and opinion in workplace and informative texts.

• **L2.14:** Recognise bias and determine whether statements represent verifiable truth or subjective interpretation.

Critical Principle: A fact is verifiable using data, records, dates, measurements, or official statistics. If a statement can be checked against records and proven true or false, it is a fact — even if you personally disagree with it.

Golden Method

Opinions reflect feelings, beliefs, interpretations, or recommendations. Look out for evaluative adjectives ('superb', 'appalling', 'vital') and modal verbs ('should', 'must', 'ought to').

Examiner Audit Trap

Just because a senior doctor or consultant says 'This is the best ward management app available', that does not make it a fact. It remains an informed professional opinion.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • NHS HEALTHCARE COMPLIANCE

Fact or Opinion • Text Analysis

Source Passage • NHS Healthcare Compliance

Extract • Hospital Ward Inspection Report Analysis:

Read the extract from the hospital audit report:
'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October. The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care throughout the winter surge. Patient discharge waiting times exceeded 3 hours.'
(a) Identify one fact.
(b) Identify one opinion.
(c) Explain why the opinion cannot be verified as an objective fact.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Identify the verifiable factual statement):** Option A: 'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October' OR Option B: 'Patient discharge waiting times exceeded 3 hours.' Both can be verified from hospital admission logs. **[1 Mark (A1 Fact)]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify the subjective opinion):** 'The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care throughout the winter surge.' **[1 Mark (A1 Opinion)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain why the opinion is unverifiable):** 'Exceptional' and 'heartwarming' are evaluative value judgments based on subjective personal feelings rather than clinical numerical metrics. **[1 Mark (A1 Justification)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

Fact or Opinion • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

Fact: 'Ward 4 admitted 142 patients in October' | Opinion: 'The nursing staff provided exceptional, heartwarming care' | Reason: It uses evaluative adjectives reflecting personal perception.

Band 4 Criteria

In Pearson Edexcel exams, always copy the exact quotation for the fact and opinion, and make sure your explanation clearly mentions subjective language or lack of measurable proof.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

DRILL

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

Fact or Opinion • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A logistics fleet report states: *'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500. They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.'*
Extract one fact and one opinion from this statement.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R2

Reading Topic 2: Words in Context & Meaning



Professional context for Words in Context & Meaning.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.10 / L2.10:** Identify meanings of words and phrases and determine how meaning is conveyed.

• **L2.11:** Understand and explain implicit and explicit meanings across extended texts.

Critical Principle: Never define a word in isolation. Look at the sentences before and after the target word to see how it operates within the passage's vocational situation.

Golden Method

Literal words express their exact dictionary definition. Figurative words create comparisons that must be translated into plain English.

Examiner Audit Trap

A word like 'critical' can mean 'finding fault' or 'of crucial clinical importance'. Always select the definition that fits the vocational scenario.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • SOCIAL CARE QUALITY ASSURANCE

Words in Context & Meaning • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Social Care Quality Assurance

Extract • Care Home Policy Handbook Vocabulary:

An extract from the residential home guidelines states:
'Staff must remain vigilant regarding subtle fluctuations in a resident's baseline vital signs.'
(a) In this context, what is the meaning of the word 'vigilant'?
(b) What is meant by 'fluctuations'?

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Define 'vigilant' using the clinical supervision context):** 'Vigilant' means being alert, watchful, observant, or carefully attentive to changes. **[1 Mark (A1 Meaning)]**
2. **Step 2 (Define 'fluctuations' in relation to vital signs):** 'Fluctuations' means variations, shifts, irregular rises and falls, or changes in measurements over time. **[1 Mark (A1 Meaning)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Words in Context & Meaning • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Vigilant: Alert, watchful, or attentively monitoring. (b) Fluctuations: Irregular changes, rises and falls, or variations.

Band 4 Criteria

Avoid using the target word itself in your explanation. Always use a clear synonym or descriptive phrase.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

DRILL

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

Words in Context & Meaning • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A safety notice reads: *'Failure to isolate electrical equipment prior to maintenance poses imminent danger.'*
Explain what is meant by 'isolate' and 'imminent' in this context.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R3 Reading Topic 3: Specialist & Technical Vocabulary



Professional context for Specialist & Technical Vocabulary.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.11 / L2.11:** Understand and explain specialist and technical vocabulary in vocational texts.

• **L2.12:** Recognise jargon and understand when glossaries, brackets, or context define technical terms.

Critical Principle: Authors of informational texts frequently define technical acronyms or jargon immediately upon first mention using parentheses (e.g. PPE – Personal Protective Equipment) or a glossary box.

Golden Method

Many specialist words combine standard roots, prefixes, and suffixes (e.g., 'bio-degradable', 'hyper-tension'). Use familiar word roots to deduce meaning.

Examiner Audit Trap

Exam questions often test whether you know that 'RIDDOR', 'COSHH', or 'MAR' refer to specific official regulations or medical records.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH & SAFETY

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Occupational Health & Safety

Extract • Warehouse Safety Induction Protocol:

A warehouse safety manual states:
'Operatives must adhere to ergonomic guidelines when handling palletized freight to mitigate musculoskeletal strain.'
(a) What is meant by 'ergonomic guidelines'?
(b) What does 'mitigate' mean in this sentence?

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Define ergonomic guidelines):** Practices or posture rules designed to fit the human body safely and minimize physical strain during lifting. **[1 Mark (A1 Definition)]**
2. **Step 2 (Define mitigate):** To reduce, lessen, alleviate, or make less severe. **[1 Mark (A1 Definition)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 2 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1/2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Rules designed for body safety and correct lifting posture. (b) To reduce, lessen, or prevent the severity of strain.

Band 4 Criteria

Keep definitions clear and simple. Explain technical jargon as if speaking to a newly hired colleague.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Specialist & Technical Vocabulary • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A pharmacy dispensing notice states: *'The oral suspension is contraindicated for patients with renal impairment.'*
Explain what is meant by (a) 'contraindicated' and (b) 'renal impairment'.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R4 Reading Topic 4: Presentational Features



Professional context for Presentational Features.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.12 / L2.12:** Recognise and explain how presentational features aid understanding and convey information.

• **L2.13:** Analyse how formatting, organizational signposts, and visual features support authorial intent.

Critical Principle: You never receive marks simply for naming a feature (e.g. 'bullet points'). You must explain WHAT that feature achieves for the reader in that specific text.

Golden Method

A main heading states the overarching topic or hooks interest; subheadings break down complex multi-step processes into scannable chunks.

Examiner Audit Trap

Alliteration, rhetorical questions, and metaphors are language techniques. Bold fonts, tables, bullet points, and headers are presentational features.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • FACILITY MANAGEMENT & SAFETY

Presentational Features • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Facility Management & Safety

Extract • Fire Evacuation Workplace Notice Analysis:

Examine a workplace emergency evacuation poster.
(a) Identify two different presentational features used in the poster.
(b) Explain how one of these features helps staff during an emergency.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Identify two distinct presentational features):** Feature 1: Bold red subheadings ('PRIMARY ASSEMBLY POINT')
   Feature 2: Numbered bullet points for step-by-step escape actions. **[2 Marks (A1 Features)]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the practical effect on the reader in an emergency):** The numbered bullet points present the evacuation sequence step-by-step so that panicked employees can follow instructions rapidly in order without having to read dense blocks of text. **[1 Mark (A1 Effect)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

Presentational Features • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Bold red subheadings AND numbered bullet points. (b) The numbered list allows staff to follow sequential escape steps rapidly during high-stress situations.

Band 4 Criteria

Never give vague answers like 'it makes it look pretty'. Always explain how it functionally assists reader comprehension.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

DRILL

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

Presentational Features • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

An NHS appointment booking portal features a prominent yellow shaded box at the top stating: *'Urgent: Please arrive 15 minutes before your scheduled scan.'* Identify the presentational feature and explain its purpose.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R5

Reading Topic 5: Layout Devices & Visual Signposting



Professional context for Layout Devices & Visual Signposting.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.12 / L2.12:** Understand how layout and structural devices organize complex information.

• **L2.13:** Analyse the relationship between textual hierarchy, columns, margins, and reader navigation.

Critical Principle: Layout is structured so the most important message occupies top-left prominence (banner headline), followed by secondary details in columns, and administrative notes in footers.

Golden Method

Ample line-spacing, margins, and cell padding isolate critical data blocks, making reading accessible for adults with dyslexia and cognitive processing differences.

Examiner Audit Trap

If asked about layout, do not summarize the words! Discuss columns, spacing, callout boxes, and alignment.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • PUBLIC HEALTH COMMUNICATIONS

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Public Health Communications

Extract • Community Clinic Health Leaflet Layout:

A vaccination guide uses a three-fold leaflet format with a separate colored sidebar titled 'Walk-in Clinic Times'.
(a) Why did the designer place clinic opening times in a dedicated sidebar?
(b) How does this layout benefit a working parent needing a booster jab?

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Explain the architectural purpose of the sidebar):** The sidebar physically separates practical logistics (times, venues) from the dense clinical information in the main body. **[1 Mark (A1 Purpose)]**
2. **Step 2 (Explain the direct benefit to the target audience):** A busy parent can immediately locate operational times without having to scan through paragraphs explaining vaccine science. **[2 Marks (A1 Benefit)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Isolates practical appointment logistics from background clinical explanations.
(b) Enables busy readers to find dates and times instantly without reading the entire document.

Band 4 Criteria

Focus on the practical vocational convenience delivered by the layout.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Layout Devices & Visual Signposting • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A staff intranet page presents payroll submission deadlines in a centered two-column table rather than continuous prose. Explain two advantages of this table layout.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R6

Reading Topic 6: Images, Graphics & Captions



Professional context for Images, Graphics & Captions.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.13 / L2.13:** Analyse how images and graphical representations support or extend written content.

• **L2.14:** Evaluate the rhetorical and persuasive impact of visual imagery in campaigning and informational texts.

Critical Principle: Images are never decorative in exam papers. They serve an explicit rhetorical function: evoking empathy, illustrating safety hazards, or demonstrating clinical anatomy.

Golden Method

The caption provides the intended interpretation of the image. Always read the caption to verify dates, identities, statistical context, or clinical significance.

Examiner Audit Trap

Saying 'The picture shows a nurse' scores 0. You must explain why the nurse was chosen: to represent frontline dedication, professionalism, or clinical expertise.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • CHARITABLE HEALTHCARE FUNDRAISING

Images, Graphics & Captions • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Charitable Healthcare Fundraising

Extract • Air Ambulance Charity Campaign Analysis:

Text A includes an image of a paramedic kneeling beside an emergency trauma pack, smiling alongside a young patient recovering from surgery.
(a) What emotion does this image evoke in potential donors?
(b) How does this image support the text's headline: 'Every Second Counts, Every Pound Saves Lives'?

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Identify the emotional response evoked):** Evokes hope, relief, warmth, gratitude, and empathy. **[1 Mark (A1 Emotion)]**
2. **Step 2 (Link image content directly to the headline message):** The smiling, healthy patient provides tangible visual proof of the life-saving impact of donor funding, demonstrating that immediate paramedic intervention leads directly to positive recovery. **[2 Marks (A1 Rhetorical Link)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Images, Graphics & Captions • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Evokes empathy, relief, and hope. (b) Provides tangible photographic proof that donor funding translates directly into saved human lives.

Band 4 Criteria

Always link the visual depiction (paramedic with recovered patient) directly to the specific words in the headline.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Images, Graphics & Captions • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A recycling campaign poster includes a photograph of sea turtles swimming amongst single-use plastic bottles. Explain why the author selected this specific image rather than just stating waste statistics.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R7

Reading Topic 7: Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques



Professional context for Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.14 / L2.14:** Identify language techniques and explain how they influence the reader.

• **L2.15:** Analyse rhetorical devices used to persuade, inform, critique, or advocate in workplace communications.

Critical Principle: To score full marks on language questions in Pearson Edexcel, follow the 3-step formula: 1. Technique Name -> 2. Direct Quote -> 3. Impact on reader thoughts/feelings.

Golden Method

The 'Rule of Three' creates rhythm, finality, and psychological memorability. Emotive words trigger emotional resonance rather than neutral logic.

Examiner Audit Trap

Writing 'it catches the reader's eye and makes them read on' is the #1 reason candidates fail language questions.

EXTENDED EXTRACT • NHS CLINICAL RECRUITMENT

PASSAGE

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Text Analysis

Source Passage • NHS Clinical Recruitment

Extract • Healthcare Recruitment Drive Article Analysis:

Read the extract:
'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives? Nursing offers a career of purpose, passion, and pride. Do not let this once-in-a-lifetime calling slip through your fingers.'
(a) Identify one rhetorical question.
(b) Identify one example of the rule of three.
(c) Explain the effect of the phrase 'slip through your fingers'.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Quote the rhetorical question exactly):** 'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives?' **[1 Mark (A1 Quote)]**
2. **Step 2 (Quote the rule of three triplet):** 'purpose, passion, and pride' **[1 Mark (A1 Quote)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain the metaphorical effect):** The metaphor 'slip through your fingers' creates a sense of loss and urgency, warning candidates that failing to apply will result in missing a precious opportunity. **[1 Mark (A1 Effect)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) 'Are you ready to make an indelible mark on patients' lives?' (b) 'purpose, passion, and pride' (c) Metaphor creating urgency and fear of missing a valuable career opportunity.

Band 4 Criteria

Copy quotations word-for-word inside quotation marks. When explaining impact, use action verbs like 'compels', 'dramatizes', 'creates urgency'.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Language Devices & Rhetorical Techniques • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A union safety flyer states: *'Tired nurses make dangerous mistakes. Safe staffing is a matter of life and death.'* Identify one language technique used in 'life and death' and explain its intended effect.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R8

Reading Topic 8: Point of View, Bias & Argumentation



Professional context for Point of View, Bias & Argumentation.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

- **L2.14:** Recognise bias and determine whether arguments are balanced or one-sided.
- **L2.16:** Trace lines of argument and evaluate whether conclusions are supported by rigorous evidence.

Critical Principle: A balanced, objective text presents both advantages and disadvantages, citing opposing perspectives before responding with evidence. A biased text omits counter-evidence entirely.

Golden Method

Bias frequently stems from vested financial, political, or institutional interests. If a software provider praises their own app, recognize inherent commercial bias.

Examiner Audit Trap

Just because an author writes with deep emotion and compelling adjectives, that does not mean their argument is factually proven.

EXTENDED EXTRACT • DIGITAL HEALTHCARE PROCUREMENT

PASSAGE

Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Digital Healthcare Procurement

Extract • Private Telehealth App Editorial Analysis:

Read the editorial written by the CEO of 'InstantDoctor Ltd':
'Traditional GP surgeries are relics of the past. Our revolutionary app guarantees consultations in 3 minutes, solving Britain's healthcare crisis overnight.'
(a) Identify the author's point of view.
(b) Give two pieces of evidence showing this text is biased.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (State the author's point of view clearly):** The author believes digital app consultations are superior to traditional GP clinics and represent the total future of healthcare. **[1 Mark (A1 Viewpoint)]**
2. **Step 2 (Identify evidence of bias):** Evidence 1: Loaded, dismissive language describing GP practices as 'relics of the past'.
   Evidence 2: Unsubstantiated hyperbole ('solving Britain's healthcare crisis overnight') written by a CEO who profits directly from app subscriptions. **[2 Marks (A1 Evidence)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Point of view: Digital telehealth apps are superior and should replace standard GP surgeries. (b) Bias evidence: 1. Insulting GP surgeries as 'relics'. 2. Vested commercial interest as company CEO making exaggerated claims without independent trial data.

Band 4 Criteria

In Level 2 papers, identifying the author's vested interest (e.g. CEO promoting their own commercial software) demonstrates high-level critical reading.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Point of View, Bias & Argumentation • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A trade union newsletter argues: *'The proposed roster overhaul is an unmitigated disaster designed solely to exploit staff.'* Identify the author's stance and explain why the phrasing demonstrates bias.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R9 Reading Topic 9: Tone, Style & Writer's Voice



Professional context for Tone, Style & Writer's Voice.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

- **L1.15 / L2.15:** Identify the tone and style of texts and explain how register communicates attitude.
- **L2.16:** Evaluate how authorial voice establishes credibility, empathy, or professional detachment.

Critical Principle: Tone is not just what is said, but HOW it is expressed: humorous, clinical, encouraging, outraged, cautionary, or authoritative.

Golden Method

Formal register uses passive voice, polysyllabic vocabulary, and objective detachment. Informal register uses colloquialisms, contractions, and direct address.

Examiner Audit Trap

A text about a tragic topic might be written in a detached, factual, clinical tone rather than an emotional one.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • HEALTHCARE PATIENT RELATIONS

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Healthcare Patient Relations

Extract • Hospital Complaint Response Letter Tone Analysis:

Read the opening paragraph:
'We have thoroughly investigated your grievance regarding your mother's care on Ward 2. We sincerely regret the unacceptable distress caused by the communication delay, and we have instituted immediate corrective safeguards.'
(a) Describe the tone.
(b) Quote two words or phrases that establish this tone.
(c) Explain why this tone is appropriate.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Describe the tone accurately):** The tone is apologetic, professional, empathetic, and constructive. **[1 Mark (A1 Tone)]**
2. **Step 2 (Quote supporting vocabulary):** Quote 1: 'sincerely regret'
   Quote 2: 'unacceptable distress'. **[1 Mark (A1 Quotes)]**
3. **Step 3 (Explain contextual appropriateness):** Validates the family's legitimate grief while reassuring them with formal accountability and systemic remedial action. **[1 Mark (A1 Appropriateness)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

MODEL

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Apologetic, empathetic, and professional. (b) 'sincerely regret' and 'unacceptable distress'. (c) Acknowledges serious distress while reassuring the complainant that corrective action has been taken.

Band 4 Criteria

Avoid generic words like 'good' or 'nice'. Use precise descriptors like 'apologetic' or 'authoritative'.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

DRILL

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

Tone, Style & Writer's Voice • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A dental hygiene flyer asks: *'Hate flossing? We get it, it feels like a chore! But your gums will thank you.'* Describe the tone and quote one colloquial phrase.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R10

Reading Topic 10: Text Types, Purpose & Audience



Professional context for Text Types, Purpose & Audience.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

- **L1.16 / L2.16:** Identify different text types, purposes, and audiences across informational and transactional materials.
- **L2.17:** Recognise structural conventions distinguishing persuasive articles, operational reports, and transactional letters.

Critical Principle: Articles persuade or entertain; Reports inform and evaluate; Manuals instruct; Letters initiate transactional requests.

Golden Method

Salutations & sign-offs indicate letters; Subject lines and CC fields indicate emails; Headings, subheadings & columns indicate articles or reports.

Examiner Audit Trap

An explanatory text tells the reader HOW something works objectively. A persuasive text aims to CHANGE the reader's opinion or compel an action.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • HEALTH AND SOCIAL CARE REGULATORY REPORTING

Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Health and Social Care Regulatory Reporting

Extract • Care Quality Commission Inspection Summary Evaluation:

You are presented with a document headed: *'CQC Provider Audit: Cedar Grove Residential Home - Ref 884-B'* featuring numbered subheadings, compliance rating tables, and statutory recommendations.
(a) Identify the text type.
(b) State the primary purpose.
(c) Identify the target audience.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Identify text type from conventions):** Formal audit report / Inspection evaluation document. **[1 Mark (A1 Text Type)]**
2. **Step 2 (Determine the primary purpose):** To evaluate, assess, and report on compliance standards and order necessary regulatory improvements. **[1 Mark (A1 Purpose)]**
3. **Step 3 (Identify target audience):** Care home management, local authority social care commissioners, and prospective residents' families. **[1 Mark (A1 Audience)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) Formal audit / inspection report. (b) To evaluate regulatory compliance and state remedial recommendations. (c) Care home managers, local council commissioners, and residents' families.

Band 4 Criteria

Audience answers should be specific. Rather than writing 'people', state 'care home management and healthcare commissioners'.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Text Types, Purpose & Audience • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A document titled: *'Staff Guidance Note: Safe Disposal of Sharps and Clinical Waste'* contains numbered imperative steps and safety symbols. Identify the text type and its primary purpose.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R11

Reading Topic 11: Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives



Professional context for Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

- **L2.17:** Compare and contrast information, ideas, and perspectives across two extended texts on the same subject.
- **L2.18:** Synthesize evidence from multiple sources and identify points of agreement and disagreement.

Critical Principle: Never write about Text A in one isolated paragraph and Text B in another. Weave them together using comparative discourse markers: 'Similarly', 'Whereas', 'In sharp contrast', 'On the other hand'.

Golden Method

High-scoring comparative answers contrast not only factual content, but the author's underlying attitudes, emotional tone, and persuasive techniques.

Examiner Audit Trap

Summarizing Text A on page 1 and Text B on page 2 scores 0 for comparison. You must compare them in the exact same sentences.

EXTENDED EXTRACT • EMERGENCY SERVICES FLEET MODERNIZATION

PASSAGE

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Emergency Services Fleet Modernization

Extract • Electric Ambulances Fleet Transition (Text A vs Text B):

Text A is a government press release promoting green emergency fleets.
Text B is an interview with an active paramedic union representative.
Compare how the two texts convey differing perspectives on replacing diesel ambulances with electric vehicles.

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Contrast authorial stance and optimism):** Text A takes an optimistic stance, claiming electric ambulances will 'slash urban emissions by 40% and save millions in fuel', whereas Text B presents a skeptical perspective focusing on operational risks. **[1 Mark (A1 Stance Contrast)]**
2. **Step 2 (Contrast perspectives on vehicle reliability and charging):** Text A emphasizes technological advancement ('rapid charging in 20 minutes'), while Text B emphasizes frontline reality ('charging stations are nonexistent in rural areas, leaving crews vulnerable during emergency surges'). **[2 Marks (A1 Synthesis with Quotes)]**
3. **Step 3 (Integrate comparative connective and conclusion):** While both texts agree emissions must fall, Text A prioritizes environmental targets, whereas Text B prioritizes patient response times and emergency safety. **[1 Mark (A1 Comparative Synthesis)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 4 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

Text A presents an enthusiastic environmental perspective, arguing green fleets will 'slash emissions by 40%', whereas Text B adopts a cautious, safety-first stance, warning that rural areas lack charging infrastructure and could endanger patients during surges.

Band 4 Criteria

Notice the use of 'whereas' and direct quotations from both texts. This structure guarantees maximum marks.

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 3 MARKS

DRILL

Comparing Texts & Contrasting Perspectives • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 3 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

Text A states: *'Remote video appointments empower patients by eliminating travel.'*
Text B states: *'Virtual appointments alienate elderly patients who lack digital skills.'*
Compare the viewpoints using a comparative connective.

✎ Write your analytical response below (3 Marks):

TOPIC BLUEPRINT • LEVEL 2 READING

R12

Reading Topic 12: Authorial Intent & Target Audience



Professional context for Authorial Intent & Target Audience.

DfE Statutory Criteria & Theoretical Architecture

Curriculum Standard:

• **L1.17 / L2.17:** Identify authorial purpose and determine why texts were produced.

• **L2.18:** Analyse how purpose dictates lexical choice, structural hierarchy, and reader call-to-actions.

Critical Principle: Professional authors choose every statistic, quote, and formatting device to drive their core motivation: securing donations, changing health habits, winning a contract, or ensuring compliance.

Golden Method

Authors speaking to teenagers adopt relatable vernacular; authors speaking to clinical directors use formal medical precision and compliance standards.

Examiner Audit Trap

A text may contain facts and statistics, but if it ends with 'Donate Now' or 'Sign the Petition', its primary purpose is persuasive advocacy.

PASSAGE

EXTENDED EXTRACT • TRANSFUSION SERVICE PUBLIC CAMPAIGN

Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Text Analysis

Source Passage • Transfusion Service Public Campaign

Extract • NHS Blood Donation Appeal Motivation Analysis:

An NHS campaign text features an emotive story of a child surviving leukaemia thanks to platelet donors, ending with: *'Give blood today. 60 minutes of your time is someone's lifetime.'*
(a) Why did the writer include the child's recovery story?
(b) What is the main purpose of the closing call to action?

Examiner Step-by-Step Analytical Protocol

1. **Step 1 (Analyse the emotional motivation for the story):** The author included the child's story to forge an emotional bond with the reader, humanizing the abstract concept of blood shortages and proving that donations save young lives. **[2 Marks (A1 Motivation)]**
2. **Step 2 (Analyse the closing call to action):** The closing statement serves to compel immediate, tangible donor registrations by contrasting the minimal personal sacrifice (60 minutes) with the immense life-saving outcome. **[1 Mark (A1 Call to Action)]**

✎ Rhetorical Markers & Subtext Notes

EXAMINER FULL MARKS BENCHMARK

MODEL

Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Band 4 Benchmark Exemplar

Official Benchmark Exemplar • 3 Marks (Pearson Edexcel Reading Level 1/2)

Band 4 Model Answer:

(a) To evoke deep empathy and prove the real-life medical impact of donating. (b) To compel immediate registration by making the sacrifice feel tiny compared to saving a child's life.

Band 4 Criteria

Identify both the emotional mechanism (empathy) and the behavioral objective (booking a donor slot).

Examiner Insight

Band 4 responses at Level 2 provide precise textual quotes paired with insightful explanations of the writer's deliberate effect on the reader.

✎ Why This Answer Achieves Band 4 Distinction

ANALYTICAL CHALLENGE • 2 MARKS

DRILL

Authorial Intent & Target Audience • Independent Practice

Examination Task Brief • 2 Marks

Comprehension & Analysis Task:

A hospice director publishes an article titled: *'Dignity at the End: Why Palliative Care Deserves Equal Funding.'* State the author's primary motivation for writing this article.

✎ Write your analytical response below (2 Marks):

EX1

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

Masterclass 1: The 75-Minute Examination Clock Strategy

Core Examination Technique

Pacing is critical on Level 2 Reading. Allocate 15 mins for thorough initial reading, 35 mins for Questions 1–10 (retrieval, language, layout, bias), and 25 mins for the synthesis & comparison tasks.

Band 4 Strategy

Read the questions before reading the passages to prime your memory.

Common Exam Pitfall

Never start writing without reading all 3 texts — later questions compare multiple texts.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 1)

EX2

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

Masterclass 2: Deconstructing Implicit Meaning & Subtext

Core Examination Technique

Level 2 examiners frequently test what is implied rather than stated. Look for euphemisms, sarcastic undertones, ironic contrasts, and what the writer deliberately omitted.

Band 4 Strategy

Ask: 'What does the writer want me to feel without directly saying it?'

Common Exam Pitfall

Do not mistake speculation for valid inference — inference must be grounded in textual clues.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 2)

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

EX3

Masterclass 3: Detecting Sophisticated Bias & Commercial Agenda

Core Examination Technique

Authors with a vested commercial or political interest often write in an authoritative, neutral tone while selectively presenting only supporting data.

Band 4 Strategy

Check the author credentials and funding source.

Common Exam Pitfall

Notice which opposing viewpoints are missing from the argument.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 3)

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

EX4

Masterclass 4: Analyzing Rhetorical Devices in Persuasive Writing

Core Examination Technique

Identify rule of three, emotive vocabulary, hyperbole, rhetorical questions, and statistics. Explain how each device manipulates reader empathy or logic.

Band 4 Strategy

Name the technique, quote the exact words, and explain the psychological effect.

Common Exam Pitfall

Do not just write 'it makes the reader think' — specify WHAT it makes them think.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 4)

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

EX5

Masterclass 5: Mastering the 11-Mark Comparison Question

Core Examination Technique

The comparison question is the highest-value question on the paper. Use an explicit 3-stage method: (1) Point of comparison, (2) Text A quote and interpretation, (3) Comparative connective (whereas, in contrast, similarly) and Text B quote.

Band 4 Strategy

Ensure balanced weight: cite evidence equally from Text A and Text B.

Common Exam Pitfall

Never analyze Text A and Text B in separate isolated paragraphs — integrate them continuously.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 5)

EX6

LEVEL 2 ANALYTICAL STRATEGY

Masterclass 6: Synthesis & Cross-Referencing Evidence

Core Examination Technique

Questions asking you to synthesize information require combining facts from Text A and Text B into a unified conclusion or actionable recommendation.

Band 4 Strategy

Combine data from both sources to create a complete answer.

Common Exam Pitfall

Clearly attribute which fact originates from Text A and which from Text B.

✎ Personal Strategic Takeaways & Checkpoints (Masterclass 6)

MOCK 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 2 • 75 MINUTES • 35 MARKS

Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 1

Examination Protocol

Instructions for Candidates:

- This paper contains 3 extended reading extracts on the theme of 'Workplace Artificial Intelligence & NHS Automation'.
- Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
- Total time: 75 minutes. Total marks: 35 marks.
- Dictionaries are strictly prohibited.

Pacing Rule

Spend 15 minutes reading all three source passages thoroughly.

Comparison Strategy

For Question 14 (the comparison question), write in continuous integrated paragraphs.

✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

M1

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

Mock 1 • Text A: The Clinical Revolution • Medical AI

Reading Passage

The deployment of automated diagnostic imaging software across NHS radiology departments has reduced scan interpretation backlogs by 42%. Dr Marcus Vance, Chief Medical Technology Officer, argues: 'Machine learning tools detect malignant micro-tumours with 96.8% precision, dramatically outperforming exhausted human clinicians working overnight shifts. Automation does not replace doctors; it rescues them from catastrophic burnout.'

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, by what percentage have scan backlogs been reduced? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** Identify two advantages of automated diagnostic software claimed by Dr Vance. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text A Language & Purpose Analysis

Reading Passage

Dr Vance acknowledges that algorithmic diagnostics require continuous oversight: 'Unsupervised automation invites algorithmic bias, especially across diverse patient demographic groups. We must retain robust clinical guardrails.'

1 **Question 3:** What does Dr Vance mean by the phrase 'algorithmic bias'? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Analyse how the writer of Text A uses emotive vocabulary to present human clinicians ('exhausted', 'catastrophic burnout'). (2 marks)

3 **Question 5:** What is the primary purpose of Text A? (1 mark)

- [ ] To demand the immediate sacking of human radiologists
- [ ] To advocate for the measured adoption of clinical AI tools
- [ ] To sell commercial software licenses to private hospitals
- [ ] To explain how to write Python code for medical algorithms

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text B: The Human Cost • Trade Union Perspective

Reading Passage

Article by Sarah Jenkins, Healthcare Workers' Union:
'Beneath the glossy tech jargon lies an aggressive cost-cutting drive. Remote diagnostic hubs dehumanize medicine, isolating vulnerable patients behind cold glowing screens. When algorithms misread atypical symptoms, who bears legal accountability? Certainly not the Silicon Valley venture capitalists profiting from NHS procurement contracts.'

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from Text B. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from Text B. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** Explain how Sarah Jenkins uses rhetorical questions and emotive language to influence the reader. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text B Tone & Text C Introduction

Reading Passage

Text C • NHS England National Implementation Guidelines:
All Trusts adopting AI tools must complete a Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) and ensure secondary validation by a senior consultant radiologist for any high-risk diagnostic classifications.

1 **Question 9:** How would you describe the overall tone of Text B? Support your answer with a quote. (2 marks)

2 **Question 10:** Identify the statutory assessment that NHS Trusts must complete according to Text C. (1 mark)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Text C: Guidelines & Governance Rules

Reading Passage

Trusts must provide mandatory 20-hour technical training for all healthcare practitioners interfacing with clinical decision-support systems. Bi-annual audits must be submitted to the Healthcare Governance Committee.

1 **Question 11:** How many hours of technical training are mandatory for staff? (1 mark)

2 **Question 12:** How frequently must clinical AI audits be submitted? (1 mark)

3 **Question 13:** Identify two presentational features in Text C that convey official regulatory authority. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1 Mock 1 • The Flagship Comparison Question (Texts A & B)

Reading Passage

Both Text A and Text B discuss the introduction of artificial intelligence in healthcare. Compare how the writers present differing perspectives on the impact of automation on staff and patient care.

1 **Question 14 (The 11-Mark Comparison Question):** In your response, compare: • The differing viewpoints on technology • How evidence and quotes are used • The tone and persuasive techniques in each text. Use comparative connectives and integrate quotes from both texts. (11 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 1

M1

Mock 1 • Synthesis & Final Evaluation

Reading Passage

Synthesize findings from all three texts to evaluate how the NHS can achieve safety while modernizing clinical operations.

1 **Question 15:** Synthesizing ideas from Text A, Text B, and Text C, explain three essential safeguards needed when introducing clinical AI tools into hospital wards. (3 marks)

MOCK 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 2 • 75 MINUTES • 35 MARKS

Official Reading Mock Examination • Paper 2

Examination Protocol

Instructions for Candidates:

- This paper contains 3 extended reading extracts on 'Remote Working, Urban Decline & The Future of Cities'.
- Answer all questions in the spaces provided.
- Time allowed: 75 minutes. Total marks: 35 marks.
- Check your answers against the official mark scheme on p86.

Top Scoring Advice

Keep your comparison structured with direct comparative connectives (in contrast, conversely).

Evidence Requirement

Ensure every claim is supported with a quotation from the source text.

✎ Personal Target Score & Time Checkpoints

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text A: The Freedom Economy • Work from Home

Reading Passage

The shift toward flexible remote working has liberated millions of British workers from soul-destroying daily commutes. Economist Priya Sharma reports: 'Remote employees save an average of £2,800 annually in rail fares and 380 hours in travel time. Productivity metrics across professional services have risen by 14%, disproving the antiquated myth that staff only work when surveilled in open-plan offices.'

1 **Question 1:** According to Text A, how much money do remote workers save on rail fares annually? (1 mark)

2 **Question 2:** Identify two benefits of remote working stated by Priya Sharma. (2 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text A Language & Argumentation

Reading Passage

Sharma notes that decentralized work stimulates regional market towns: 'Spending that once flowed exclusively into Central London now invigorates local bakeries, high streets, and community enterprises across the Home Counties.'

1 **Question 3:** What does Sharma mean by 'decentralized work'? (1 mark)

2 **Question 4:** Analyse how the writer of Text A uses emotive phrasing ('soul-destroying', 'liberated', 'antiquated myth') to persuade the reader. (2 marks)

3 **Question 5:** Identify the primary purpose of Text A. (1 mark)

- [ ] To persuade readers that remote working benefits individuals and regional economies
- [ ] To advise people how to buy cheap rail season tickets
- [ ] To criticize employees who spend money in local bakeries
- [ ] To announce the closure of all train lines into London

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text B: The Hollowed High Street • Chamber of Commerce

Reading Passage

Statement by Arthur Pendelton, City Centre Retail Coalition:
'Our city centres are becoming ghost towns. Footfall across commercial districts has plunged by 35%, driving hundreds of independent sandwich bars, dry cleaners, and family-owned cafes into bankruptcy. Corporate landlords and remote workers abandon the civic ecosystem that sustained British commerce for generations. Without urgent return-to-office mandates, urban culture faces irreversible extinction.'

1 **Question 6:** Extract one fact from Text B. (1 mark)

2 **Question 7:** Extract one opinion from Text B. (1 mark)

3 **Question 8:** Explain how Pendelton uses catastrophic imagery ('ghost towns', 'bankruptcy', 'extinction') to convey urgency. (2 marks)

M2

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

Mock 2 • Text B Tone & Text C Introduction

Reading Passage

Text C • Parliamentary Commission on Future Urban Planning:
Recommendation 1: Local authorities must grant expedited planning permission for converting vacant commercial office premises into affordable residential apartments and creative co-working spaces.

1 **Question 9:** How would you describe the tone of Text B? Support your answer with a quotation. (2 marks)

2 **Question 10:** According to Text C, what planning permission should local authorities grant? (1 mark)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Text C: Urban Regeneration Policy

Reading Passage

Recommendation 2: Establish 'Enterprise Hubs' in municipal town halls providing subsidised gigabit broadband, hot-desking, and childcare facilities. Funding will be allocated from the National Infrastructure Levelling Fund.

1 **Question 11:** Name two facilities provided in Enterprise Hubs according to Text C. (2 marks)

2 **Question 12:** Which national fund will finance the Enterprise Hubs? (1 mark)

3 **Question 13:** Explain how the layout of Text C (numbered recommendations) helps policy makers. (1 mark)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • The Flagship Comparison Question (Texts A & B)

Reading Passage

Both Text A and Text B explore the consequences of the rise in remote working. Compare how the writers present contrasting arguments regarding the social and economic impact on communities.

1 **Question 14 (The 11-Mark Comparison Question):** In your answer, compare: • The opposing views on where economic value is created • How each writer characterizes remote workers • The contrasting tone, language, and stylistic devices. Include quotes from both texts. (11 marks)

OFFICIAL EXAMINATION BOOKLET • READING PAPER 2

M2

Mock 2 • Synthesis & Future Recommendations

Reading Passage

Synthesize ideas from all three texts to suggest a balanced model for future working arrangements.

1 **Question 15:** Synthesizing insights from Text A, Text B, and Text C, propose three strategies for balancing remote employee flexibility with the survival of urban town centres. (3 marks)

RUB1

THE 11-MARK COMPARISON QUESTION BAND DESCRIPTORS

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 1 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Band 4 (9–11 marks): Perceptive, detailed comparison across both texts; continuous direct comparative connectives; insightful analysis of perspectives and stylistic devices; balanced, well-chosen quotations.
Band 3 (6–8 marks): Clear comparison with sound identification of similarities and differences; appropriate quotes from both texts; mostly balanced structure.
Band 2 (3–5 marks): Basic comparison with superficial links; relies heavily on paraphrase; unbalanced coverage favoring one text.
Band 1 (1–2 marks): Isolated comments on one or both texts with no meaningful comparative synthesis.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 1)

RUB2

TONE, VOICE & REGISTER ASSESSMENT CRITERIA (L2.15)

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 2 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Full marks awarded for identifying the specific adjective defining tone (e.g. indignant, urgent, impassioned, clinical, detached) paired with accurate lexical evidence and explanation of reader impact.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 2)

RUB3

IMPLICIT MEANING & SUBTEXT MARKING GUIDANCE (L2.11)

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 3 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Candidates must demonstrate insight into authorial subtext, irony, or underlying assumptions rather than merely repeating literal surface statements.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 3)

RHETORICAL & LANGUAGE DEVICES ASSESSMENT (L2.14)

RUB4

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 4 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Examiners award marks for identifying the rhetorical device (hyperbole, rule of three, rhetorical question) AND explaining its exact psychological or persuasive influence on the target audience.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 4)

EVALUATING BIAS & ARGUMENTATION CRITERIA (L2.16)

RUB5

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 5 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Full marks require candidates to distinguish verifiable factual claims from subjective vested interests, identifying omissions or unbalanced evidence.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 5)

RUB6

SYNTHESIS & CROSS-REFERENCING STANDARDS (L2.18)

Level 2 Assessment Criteria • Part 6 of 6

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Marking Protocol

Marks awarded for correctly extracting and synthesizing disparate pieces of information from two or three separate source texts to draw a valid comprehensive conclusion.

✎ Personal Band 4 Action Plan & Audit Notes (Part 6)

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX

Complete Worked Solutions, Lexicon & Alphabetical Index

TOPIC 1: FACT OR OPINION SOLUTIONS

R1 **Analysis:** Fact: 'The electric delivery vans cut depot fuel expenditure by £14,500.' (verifiable in accounting records) Opinion: 'They are undeniably the most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today.' (subjective aesthetic judgment).
Benchmark Answer: Fact: Reduced fuel expenditure by £14,500 | Opinion: Most stylish commercial vehicles on British roads today. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 2: WORDS IN CONTEXT & MEANING SOLUTIONS

R2 **Analysis:** Isolate: Disconnect, cut off, or safely separate from power supply.
Imminent: About to happen immediately, forthcoming, or looming.
Benchmark Answer: Isolate = Disconnect from power. Imminent = About to occur immediately. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 3: SPECIALIST & TECHNICAL VOCABULARY SOLUTIONS

R3 **Analysis:** (a) Contraindicated: Not recommended, inadvisable, or dangerous to administer.
(b) Renal impairment: Kidney damage, kidney disease, or reduced kidney function.
Benchmark Answer: (a) Not suitable/unsafe for use. (b) Kidney damage or dysfunction. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 4: PRESENTATIONAL FEATURES SOLUTIONS

R4 **Analysis:** Feature: Shaded/coloured text box (callout box / alert banner).
Purpose: Draws immediate visual attention to critical arrival instructions before the patient reads anything else.
Benchmark Answer: Feature: Shaded callout banner. Purpose: Highlights time-sensitive arrival requirements immediately. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 5: LAYOUT DEVICES & VISUAL SIGNPOSTING SOLUTIONS

R5 **Analysis:** Advantage 1: Aligns cut-off dates alongside payment dates in clear corresponding rows.
Advantage 2: Makes it fast and easy for payroll clerks to look up specific months without missing vital deadlines.
Benchmark Answer: 1. Aligns matching data horizontally. 2. Provides quick scanning for specific monthly deadlines. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC 6: IMAGES, GRAPHICS & CAPTIONS SOLUTIONS

R6 **Analysis:** Reason: The photo creates emotional distress by showing innocent wildlife directly harmed by plastic, making the crisis personal and urgent rather than an abstract numerical statistic.
Benchmark Answer: Generates emotional distress/empathy and provides direct visual proof of harm to marine wildlife. **[2 Marks]**

TOPIC TECH

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REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

TOPIC 12: AUTHORIAL INTENT & TARGET AUDIENCE SOLUTIONS

R12 **Analysis:** Motivation: To campaign and advocate for increased statutory and charitable funding for palliative care services by emphasizing patient dignity.
Benchmark Answer: To advocate for equal government and charitable funding for hospice and palliative care.
[2 Marks]

OFFICIAL READING MOCK EXAMINATION 1 • FULL MARK SCHEME & SOLUTIONS (35 MARKS)

Q1 42% **[1m]**
Direct retrieval from Text A paragraph 1.

Q2 Detects malignant micro-tumours with 96.8% precision / Rescues clinicians from catastrophic burnout **[2m]**
1m for each valid point.

Q3 Systematic errors in computer algorithms that unfairly disadvantage specific demographic groups **[1m]**
Conceptual vocabulary definition.

Q4 Words like 'catastrophic burnout' elicit deep empathy, framing automation as a compassionate saviour rather than a managerial replacement **[2m]**
1m for quote/analysis, 1m for impact.

Q5 B: To advocate for the measured adoption of clinical AI tools **[1m]**
Multiple choice key.

Q6 Remote diagnostic hubs are being deployed / Tech companies hold NHS procurement contracts **[1m]**
Verifiable fact.

Q7 Remote hubs dehumanize medicine / Software venture capitalists profit excessively **[1m]**
Subjective value judgment.

Q8 Rhetorical question ('who bears legal accountability?') casts doubt on corporate safety, positioning patients as exploited victims **[2m]**
1m for device/quote, 1m for impact.

Q9 Impassioned, indignant, and skeptical ('cold glowing screens', 'irreversible extinction') **[2m]**
1m for tone label, 1m for quote.

Q10 Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) **[1m]**
Direct statutory retrieval.

Q11 20 hours **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q12 Bi-annually (twice a year) **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q13 Numbered legal clauses and formal regulatory headings convey strict statutory compliance **[2m]**
1m for feature, 1m for effect.

Q14 **Band 4 Model Answer (11 Marks):**
Text A presents a progressive, technological perspective, portraying AI as a vital clinical asset that 'rescues' exhausted doctors from burnout. In sharp contrast, Text B adopts an indignant trade-union stance, contending that technology 'dehumanizes medicine' and serves corporate profit.

Furthermore, whereas Text A validates its argument using quantitative medical statistics ('96.8% precision', '42% backlog reduction') to project scientific authority, Text B relies on evocative rhetorical questions and emotive

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

OFFICIAL READING MOCK EXAMINATION 2 • FULL MARK SCHEME & SOLUTIONS (35 MARKS)

Q1 £2,800 annually **[1m]**
Direct retrieval from Text A.

Q2 Saves 380 travel hours / Increases professional productivity by 14% **[2m]**
1m for each point.

Q3 Working away from a centralized central office, typically from home or local co-working spaces **[1m]**
Conceptual definition.

Q4 Phrases like 'soul-destroying' and 'antiquated myth' delegitimize traditional office attendance, portraying remote work as enlightened progress **[2m]**
1m for quote, 1m for persuasive effect.

Q5 A: To persuade readers that remote working benefits individuals and regional economies **[1m]**
Multiple choice key.

Q6 Footfall across commercial districts has plunged by 35% **[1m]**
Verifiable statistic.

Q7 Our city centres are becoming ghost towns / Urban culture faces irreversible extinction **[1m]**
Subjective hyperbolic opinion.

Q8 Catastrophic language creates an existential crisis, pressurizing policymakers to mandate office returns **[2m]**
1m for quote, 1m for impact.

Q9 Alarmist, urgent, and despairing ('bankruptcy', 'abandoned', 'extinction') **[2m]**
1m for tone label, 1m for quote.

Q10 Expedited planning permission for converting vacant offices into residential apartments and co-working hubs **[1m]**
Direct policy retrieval.

Q11 Subsidised gigabit broadband / hot-desking / childcare facilities (any two) **[2m]**
1m each.

Q12 National Infrastructure Levelling Fund **[1m]**
Direct retrieval.

Q13 Numbered recommendations provide an unambiguous sequential roadmap for local council executives **[1m]**
Layout functionality.

Q14 Band 4 Model Answer (11 Marks):
Text A celebrates remote working as a triumph of individual autonomy and regional redistribution, arguing that saving '£2,800' and '380 hours' stimulates suburban high streets. Conversely, Text B laments this development as an economic catastrophe, warning that a 35% footfall collapse threatens urban commercial centres with 'irreversible extinction'.

Stylistically, Text A employs an optimistic, professional register grounded in productivity research, whereas Text B leverages dramatic, apocalyptic imagery ('ghost towns', 'abandon the civic ecosystem') to lobby for corporate office mandates.

While Text A champions the worker's personal sovereignty, Text B prioritizes the collective civic community. Ultimately, Text C bridges this ideological divide by proposing the pragmatic conversion of vacant urban offices into hybrid co-working hubs and residential dwellings. **[11m]**
Comprehensive Band 4 comparative synthesis.

Q15 (1) Convert obsolete commercial offices into affordable housing; (2) Create subsidized municipal co-working hubs; (3) Adopt hybrid working schedules combining office collaboration with remote focus days **[3m]**
1m for each synthesized policy.

CRITI ANAL

Algor autom

Comp contra contra

Conn word

Coun dispro

Euph consi

Hype empha

Impli within

Irony signif

Objec facts f

Regis specif

Rheto persua

Subje interp

Synth multip

Tone: comm

Veste influe

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